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first goal for the club after arriving in the summer. The Gunners also handed a debut to 15-year-old Max Dowman, who played his part by winning a late penalty, which Gyokeres converted.

United, desperate for its first win, could only manage a 1-1 draw against Fulham, leaving Amorim frustrated. The Portuguese admitted post the match that his side had failed to execute its attacking philosophy after conceding.

Pep Guardiola saw his Manchester City side begin with a 4-0 thrashing of Wolverhampton Wanderers, but it failed to carry that momentum into the next match, succumbing to a 0-2 loss against a rejuvenated Tottenham Hotspur under new manager Thomas Frank.

FIFA Club World Cup champion Chelsea had a frustrating start with a goalless draw against Crystal Palace, but quickly picked up pace with a 5-1 win over West Ham in its following outing.

Everton, welcoming the new season at its new home — the Hill Dickinson Stadium — won its first match at the venue, defeating

Brighton & Hove Albion 2-0, after having earlier suffered a 1-0 defeat away to Leeds.

Among the promoted sides, Sunderland enjoyed a grand return to the English top-flight with a 3-0 win against West Ham, but was beaten 0-2 by Burnley, another newly-promoted side.

With two matches played, Arsenal leads the table with six points, followed by Tottenham Hotspur, also on six but with an inferior goal difference. Chelsea and Nottingham Forest occupy third and fourth, while Liverpool, having played a game less (at the time of writing), sits fifth, with City in sixth. United is 16th with one point from two games.

La Liga

La Liga has mostly been a two-team affair in recent times, with Barcelona and Real Madrid usually coming out on top and Atletico Madrid occasionally playing

Early surge: Kylian Mbappe followed up his penalty against Osasuna with a brace against Oviedo. REUTERS

Big match theory: Manchester United's clash with Arsenal was the highlight of the opening gameweek.

REUTERS

signings such as Matheus Cunha, Bryan Mbeumo, and Benjamin Sesko. And while early signs showed an improvement in United's football, the Red Devils lacked the finishing quality and were undone by an Arsenal corner converted by Riccardo Calafiori.

Arsenal followed the narrow win with a 5-0 triumph over newly-promoted Leeds United, with Viktor Gyokeres (**left**) scoring his

